



## Celebrations Across Stunning Destinations in Sri Lanka!

Claude Gunasekera

**Colombo | December 26 | Sri Lanka's hospitality industry offers a diverse range of New Year's Eve celebrations this year, catering to various preferences from vibrant beach parties to luxurious hotel galas and cultural experiences across the country gearing up for a lively transition into 2026. Many key destinations in Colombo including Negambo, South, North and Hills are providing unique festivities.**

Special Feature Article by Claude Gunasekera | In Colombo, the capital city is characterized by high-energy urban celebrations and luxury hotel events. Gala Dinners are expect as grand buffet spreads or multi-course set menus at various hotels accompanied by live music, dance performances, and a countdown to midnight adding a unique flair to the dining experience. Gala Dinners and Buffets are available at almost all the star class hotels featuring international cuisine, local delicacies, live cooking stations, and a wide array of desserts. These are often held in their main restaurants or grand ballrooms. Hotels also hosts specific themed parties in its ballrooms or outdoor spaces, featuring DJs and live bands. Guests will have good vantage points for the city's fireworks displays. Rooftop bars and hotels provide prime viewing spots for fireworks over Galle Face Green and Port City. **The grand firework show at Town Hall and Mount Lavinia Beach are also significant events in Colombo.** Many beach resorts across the locations in Sri Lanka host their own New Year's Eve events. The peak travel season in January means a

significant influx of both local and international tourists, contributing to the vibrant atmosphere across the island. For those seeking a more relaxed, beach-centric New Year, the southern coastal towns are popular choices. Special NYE dinners are typically held in their main restaurants or outdoor areas, offering stunning views of the ocean and a festive atmosphere. Coastal resorts incorporate themes related to their location, such as tropical or marine-inspired parties. **Mirissa** is renowned for its barefoot dancing, bonfires, and ocean-front parties. Venues like **Doctor's House, Zephyr Restaurant & Bar, and Surf Bar Mirissa** offer DJs, fire dancers, and lantern-lit skies, creating a festive yet intimate atmosphere. Mirissa is generally known for its continuous party vibe, especially during peak seasons. **Hikkaduwa** transforms into a massive beach rave, featuring foam parties, fireworks on the sand, and DJs spinning tracks from sunset to sunrise. Vibrations Music Bar and Funky de Bar are highlighted as key spots for these energetic celebrations, attracting backpackers and adventurous travelers. The firework display by **Hikka Tranz Hotel** is particularly famous and draws many people to the area. Hikka Tranz by Cinnamon is known for its prominent fireworks show in Hikkaduwa.

**Galle** offers a blend of history and celebration within its Dutch Fort precincts. Intimate bars, live music, and beachside parties cater to couples and culture enthusiasts looking for a more stylish and quieter countdown. **The Taphouse by R&R, Fort Printers Courtyard Bar, and The Hammock Lounge Bar** are popular choices, offering craft beers, elegant dinners, and relaxed DJ music respectively. Viewing fireworks from the lighthouse or fort walls provides a unique experience before rejoining the parties.

**Unawatuna** provides a more relaxed yet lively celebration, with beach resorts hosting parties, fireworks, and DJs against sunset views. **Happy Banana Beach Club** is noted as the biggest party venue, while **Koha Surf Lounge** and **Kingfisher Beach Bar** offer tropical cocktails, live DJs, and beachfront festivities, including midnight champagne toasts. **Hikka Tranz by Cinnamon, Cinnamon Bey Beruwala, Cinnamon Bentota Beach** Cinnamon's coastal resorts offer a distinct NYE experience, focusing on beachside celebrations. These properties are famous for their vibrant beach parties, featuring DJs, live music, fire dancers, and spectacular fireworks displays over the ocean..



Beyond the coastal parties, **Kandy** offers a culturally rich New Year's Eve experience, while perhaps not as focused on large-scale parties. Kandy provides culinary delights and cultural exploration, including tours of local markets, traditional village cooking experiences, visits to the Temple of the Tooth Relic, and Kandyan Dance Shows. This option appeals to those looking for a deeper engagement with Sri Lankan heritage during the festive period. **Kandy Myst by Cinnamon** will also host a NYE dinner and **Cinnamon Citadel Kandy** is indeed hosting a New Year's Eve Gala Dinner Dance offering a blended celebration of luxury with cultural elements. Gala dinner, live music, and perhaps some traditional Sri Lankan performances, all set against the backdrop of the Mahaweli River and

the Kandyan hills. **Amaya Kandy** Gala Dinner on December 31 from 7.30 pm onwards to midnight. Rs.15,000 net per person. Couple Dance Competition, Lucky Room No. Draw, Raffle Draw & Fireworks at 12 midnight.



**Ravana Pool Club, Ella** is hosting themed pool parties from Christmas, culminating in a large-scale New Year's Eve (NYE) celebration on December 31. The venue runs back-to-back daytime-to-night parties starting from 11:00 AM, with a distinct theme, food, drinks, and entertainment style. Six themed pool parties, ranging from family-friendly celebrations to tropical, couples', Bollywood, cultural, and ladies-only party concepts. The day features themed food, cocktails, DJ music, and poolside experiences. The flagship Ravana NYE event on December 31, with live DJs and percussion, a countdown celebration, complimentary sparkling wine, special food and drink menus, and exclusive pool and lounge packages. Entry fees are redeemable against food and beverages, with higher-tier packages available for NYE (VIP lounges, group seating, reserved areas). Overall, the club positions this as a full festive week in one location, targeting families, couples, groups of friends, and partygoers looking to stay in Ella and celebrate continuously through to New Year's Eve and beyond.

2026 NYE Dinner Dance at Goldi Sands Hotel Negambo with Live music by Thr Great Members. Lavish New Year's Dinner Buffet, Midnight Toast and Countdown Celebration, Prizes and Surprises. LKR 10,000 per adult and 5500 per child.



**Minor Hotels** properties in Sri Lanka also hosts New Year's Eve celebrations for December 31 while specific details for December 31, 2025, are not yet publicly available as of today 26. We can infer potential offerings based on their typical New Year's Eve programming and the types of experiences each property generally provides. **Anantara Peace Haven Tangalle Resort** typically offers sophisticated New Year's Eve galas, often featuring elaborate dinner buffets or set menus, live entertainment (bands, DJs), fireworks displays, and themed parties. Given its beachfront location, a beachside countdown and celebration are highly probable. **Anantara Kalutara** is expected to host a grand New Year's Eve celebration. This could include a gala dinner with international and local cuisine,

live music, and a festive atmosphere, likely culminating in a fireworks display over the lagoon or ocean. AVANI properties generally focus on contemporary and relaxed luxury. For New Year's Eve, **AVANI Bentota Resort & Spa** is likely to offer a special dinner event, possibly a buffet or a set menu with live entertainment, and a countdown celebration. Its beachfront location makes a beach party or a dinner with ocean views a strong possibility. **AVANI Kalutara Resort**, would likely feature a New Year's Eve dinner with entertainment and a festive atmosphere to ring in the New Year. Guests interested in specific details for December 31, at any of these Minor Hotels properties in Sri Lanka should monitor the official websites of each individual hotel or contact them directly. For those seeking a unique wildlife-centric NYE, Cinnamon Wild Yala resort near Yala National Park offer special dinners with a focus on nature and tranquility, while still providing festive entertainment and a countdown.



As the final hours of the year gently unfold, Colombo's most iconic address, **Galle Face Hotel** presents a trio of curated New Year's Eve experiences each distinct in mood, flavour and rhythm, yet united by the hotel's legendary hospitality and heritage and invites you to celebrate the New Year, on 31st December. The Gala Dinner at Jubilee Ballroom for a classic New Year's Eve celebration steeped in tradition and splendour. Beginning at 7.00 pm. guests will enjoy an indulgent New Year's dinner buffet priced at LKR 20,000 net per person. The evening is elevated by live entertainment from Nalin & Star Combination. Exclusive lucky draws, and special group offers making it the perfect choice for families, friends, and corporate groups seeking an elegant countdown to midnight. Año Nuevo al Ritmo del Mambo at **King of the Mambo** for those drawn to colour, rhythm and celebration. King of the Mambo promises a vibrant Latin-inspired New Year's Eve from 8.00 p.m. to 2.00 a.m. Flavourful Latin dinner buffet at LKR 15,000 nett per person. A limited edition fine dining experience at 1864 from 8.00 p.m. to 11.00 p.m. Guests can savour a meticulously crafted five-course set menu paired with wines, priced at LKR 20,000 net per person.

A Feast for Every Taste at the **Cinnamon Life at City of dreams** on December 31, with a curated selection of dining experiences across signature restaurants. A Feast to Ring in 2026 at **Quizine, Level 9**, ideal for families and groups looking to celebrate in a warm, convivial setting. Midnight in Tokyo at **Yoroko, Level 23**, serves an elegant six-course menu highlighting contemporary Japanese flavours. At **Bistro des Marées, Level 23**, Seven Senses of New Year's Eve offers seven carefully curated courses paired with fine spirits for a luxurious dining experience. Meanwhile, Seven Courses to Midnight at **Staten Bar & Grill, Level 23**, with the celebration continuing at the after-party at **Gatz**. Family-Style Festivities at **Sapphire Dragon, Level 23**, showcases Cantonese and Sichuan specialties served alongside a festive beverage package.



**Qawwali Night: Level 23** a Feast to Sing in the New Year at Indiya, **The Lumina Ballroom, Level 7**, features live performances by celebrated Sri Lankan vocalists including Falan, Corrine, Clifford, Geoffrey, Rukshan, Damian, and Sohan, alongside powerhouse bands Aroh and Flame. Hosted by Kumar De Silva, the evening spans iconic hits from past decades to modern favourites, complemented by raffle draws, exclusive prizes, and a memorable midnight countdown. **At Level 23, Countdown at Gatz** invites guests to dance to live beats, enjoy exclusive beverage offers, and toast the New Year under the stars. **C'est la Vie at Pool + Bar 09, Level 09**, transforms the poolside rooftop bar into a Mediterranean-inspired setting, with music and ambience curated by Uncle's and Kaizen Productions. **Flux on Level 24** hosts a rooftop celebration set against sweeping skyline views, where DJ beats, open skies, and the city lights provide a striking backdrop for welcoming 2026. Whether guests choose a refined dining experience, a rooftop countdown, a poolside gathering, or the grandeur of the ballroom, Cinnamon Life at City of Dreams offers a blend of culinary excellence and celebration to ring in the New Year in style.



**Nüwa City of Dreams Sri Lanka** will welcome the New Year with an elegant New Year's Eve Grand Dinner Buffet on 31 December 2025 from 7.00 PM onwards at the Crystal Lounge, Level 25. The dinner is priced at LKR 15,000 net per person. For reservations and further information, contact +94 76 136 5759.

New Year's Eve Celebration at **NH Collection Colombo at AYU**, complete with joyful flavours and live entertainment. Kids can enjoy their celebration at Aditya with a special buffet, fun activities, drinks, and cozy movie night. 9.00 pm – 11.00 pm. LKR 12,500 net for Adults pp. and for Kids only LKR 5000 net pp. **The Grand Masquerade New Year's Celebration at the Ball Room at NH Collection Colombo** with Grand Gala Dinner, a late night Breakfast, 2 bottles special offer for a table of 10. . LKR 30,000 net pp. 31st December from 7.00pm – 1.00am. **NH Colombo – Rooftop NYE** 9pm – 3am Rooftop Bar & Lounge.

**Shangri-La Colombo at Horizons Lounge** NYE Six Course Dinner crafted for the occasion paired with a glass of bubbly and skyline views that shimmer with anticipation. 31 December 8.00 pm to 12.00 mn. Priced from LKR 29,950 ++ where the lights of Colombo meets the calm Indian Ocean. Dancing into Midnight "Mamma Mia" New

Year's Eve Gala at the **Ballroom Shangri-La Hambantota**. Indulge in a Festive Feast at Central, Shangri-La Colombo, New Year Eve Dinner Buffet – 31st December 6.30pm to 10.30 pm for LKR 13,950 ++ pp. New Year Lunch Buffet on 1st January from 12.30 pm – 3.30 pm at LKR 9900/- per person. New Year Day Dinner Buffet on 1st January from 6.30 pm – 10.30 pm for Rs. 13.950++ per person. For table reservation WhatsApp +94778174529.

Step into 2026 in style at **Flow, at Hilton Colombo Residences**, where an evening of culinary delights, sparkling toasts, and unforgettable moments awaits. This New Year's Eve, Flow invites you to experience a night curated for celebration, from handpicked festive flavors to lively entertainment that will keep the energy buzzing until the clock strikes midnight. Guests will be treated to a sumptuous buffet featuring seasonal favorites and gourmet creations. The festivities do not stop at the table. Raise your glass for a midnight toast, enjoy live entertainment by a DJ, and take part in a raffle draw with exciting prizes. Guests are welcome to bring their own liquor (BYOB) for an added personal touch to the celebrations. Hilton Honors members can enjoy special savings, and those paying with HSBC Credit Cards on bills over Rs. 5,000 receive 25 percent off. Celebrate the start of 2026 at Flow at Hilton Colombo Residences, where every bite, every toast, and every laugh promises to create memories that will last all year long. 31 December from 7:00 pm onwards at Flow, Hilton Colombo Residences. LKR. 20,000 net per person

**The Cinnamon Hotels & Resorts** chain is renowned for its elaborate and diverse New Year's Eve (NYE) celebrations across its properties in Sri Lanka. These events typically cater to a wide range of preferences, from luxurious gala dinners and themed parties to family-friendly entertainment and vibrant beachside festivities.

**Cinnamon Grand Colombo**: is consistently one of the most sought-after venues for NYE in the capital. They usually offer multiple celebration options within the hotel: **Black & Gold Masquerade**: New Year's Eve Gala on 31 December, 8 pm onwards at Oak Room, Entertainment by Redeemers (Dress code: Lounge). Pre-Dinner Cocktail at the Atrium and Gala dinner followed by the breakfast buffet. Two special beverages & two vineyard specialties. LKR 35,000 net per person. Reservations: Call +94 777188485. The **Grand Breeze Countdown Party** on 31 Dec, 7 pm onwards at Breeze Bar with DJ Jason to spin the decks and electrifying beats of Jay on Drums. LKR 12,000 nett per person. Reservations: call +94 765604972.



**Cinnamon Lakeside**: The Great Gatsby Gala on 31 December, 8PM - 2AM at King's Court. LKR 30,000 Net Per Person. Special Beverage Served on Arrival, Lavish Gala Dinner Buffet, Midnight Toast with Bubbly. Entertainment by D Major. Guest Artist: Corrine Almeda & Monique Willie. Free Access to the Longest Buffet in Town. Table Served Breakfast from 1:30 AM. The event includes a Raffle Draw. Reservations: call 071 249 1491. The **Legendary Lakeside Party Returns With the Longest Buffet in Town** on 31

December, 8PM - 2AM. The Dining Room, Royal Thai, Long Feng & Colombar combined. LKR 22,000 Net Per Person. Live Entertainment by OHME & Grace Dance. Special Performance by Guest Artist Corrine Almeda. A Glass of Bubbly for the Midnight Toast. Breakfast Served from 1:30 AM at Colombar. Reservations: call 071 249 1491. **Cinnamon Red:** New Year's Eve Party on 31 December, 8pm – 2am at Cloud Red. Live Music & Beverage offers LKR 17,500 nett per person. LKR 6,000 redeemable on beverages. Reservations: Call 0112 145145.



Ring in the New Year at the Taj Samudra! Dance the night away with Doctor Band and a thrilling Dinner Dance, followed by DJ Shane spinning into the New Year from 8pm – 3am. Indulge in a Gala International Dinner Buffet and wake up to a Breakfast Buffet. Enjoy BYOB, exciting entrance raffles, and table draws with amazing prizes. Celebrate New Year's Eve in style; unforgettable vibes, music, and memories await. Inquiries please call the Festivity Desk on 011-2446622. A highlight of New Year's Eve celebrations at this property is typically a grand countdown to midnight, often accompanied by spectacular fireworks displays, especially at Taj Samudra with its prime oceanfront location in Galle Face, Colombo. The Grand Marquee – LKR 23,000 Net per adult person and Children between 5 – 12 years of age, LKR 15,000 per head. Inquiries and reservation call 2446622.

**ITC Ratnadipa** in Colombo is hosting its inaugural New Year's Eve celebration to welcome 2025, offering a variety of options for guests. Ahasa, located on the 29th floor, will feature live music by OHME, inventive cocktails, and food, with sweeping views of the night sky, Indian Ocean, and city fireworks. LKR 20,000 nett, redeemable on food and beverages. Avartana is offering a carefully curated 13-course menu for both vegetarians and non-vegetarians at Rs. 17,470 nett. The Indian Ocean Pavilion will host a grand New Year's Eve Dinner buffet, priced at Rs. 16,999 nett, featuring a diverse selection of international cuisine. Yi Jing will present its "Wok Feast" for Rs. 14,999, offering a curated set menu of Chinese-style sharing dishes and desserts paired with fine beverages. Peshawri will serve its regular menu for a more relaxed celebration.

Dinner Buffet at **Mandarina Colombo** and **Marine Bay Colombo** on December 31. Mandarin Colombo, known for its modern amenities and central location, would likely offer a lavish international dinner buffet featuring a diverse range of cuisines, including Sri Lankan specialties, Asian, and Western dishes. Events include live music, entertainment, and a countdown celebration to midnight. Marine Bay Colombo, follows a similar pattern to other upscale coastal establishments, would likely focus on a seafood-rich buffet given its name and potential proximity to the ocean, possibly incorporating fresh catches and a vibrant, celebratory atmosphere. Both venues are expected to offer special packages, and perhaps alcoholic beverage options for an additional charge.

**The Kingsbury Colombo** is hosting the New Year's Eve 2025, offering a range of dining and entertainment options. Harbour Court

will feature Dinner Buffet on December 31st, with two seating's available: 7:00 p.m. to 9:00 p.m. and 9:30 p.m. to 11:30 p.m., priced at LKR 15,000 nett per person. Yue Chuan will offer an "All You Can Eat" menu for both lunch and dinner on December 31st, costing LKR 8,500 nett per person. For Japanese cuisine enthusiasts, Tenkū will present an Eleven-course Special Tasting Menu on New Year's Eve from 7:00 p.m. to Midnight, priced at LKR 12,000 nett per person. Ocean will also have an à la carte New Year's Eve Dinner from 6:00 p.m. to Midnight, with a minimum spend of LKR 13,500 nett per person. The Honey Beach Club will host its signature New Year's Eve event, "Dancing Into 2026," featuring live music from Infinity and DJ E2, starting at 7:00 p.m. onwards. This event includes an International Dinner Buffet and a Sri Lankan Breakfast Buffet, with tickets at LKR 20,000 nett per person. Sky Lounge will offer an elevated experience with its "Party in the Sky" New Year's Eve event, featuring The Kingdom, alongside corporate celebration packages, festive set menus, and seasonal cocktails. The Kingsbury also provides options for those celebrating at home, including Seasonal Roasts and customizable festive hampers, with five-star delivery available through Indulgence. Additionally, special offers are available for families, where children under 6 dine free, and those aged 6 – 10 receive a 50% discount on buffet dining.

**Mount Lavinia Hotel** welcome the NYE in Parisian Style. The Dinner Dance "Moulin Rouge - Une Nuit à Paris" Step into a world of glamour and excitement at the world-famous Terrace. The ticket



priced at LKR, 28,500, which includes; Welcome Cocktail at the Courtyard Grand Gala Dinner, Live entertainment by X-IT with Kevin Almeida, DJ to keep you dancing all night, Midnight Fireworks & Breakfast, A special beverage offer for tables of 10. For tickets and reservations call 077 311 2399 / 011 2 711 711.

**Browns Hotels & Resorts** has indicated a commitment to continuing the excitement with an attractive seasonal line-up of activities and curated experiences across all its properties. Based on past celebrations, it is highly probable that guests can anticipate spectacular events similar to those held for New Year's Eve 2024, which included mesmerizing fireworks displays at locations like **Club Hotel Dolphin**, **Thaala Bentota**, and **Hotel Sigiriya**.

Special Dinner Menu for New Year's Eve at **Thai Boulevard, Colombo** offers exciting new dishes complementing their usual authentic Thai offerings, with a festive vibe. For reservations contact 0112 055 425. **Barbeque Nation Sri Lanka** offers a special menu for the New Year with a Live Counter, Buffet and Dessert Corner at special price on 31st December and 1st January. Book your table +94 74 411 0322. Other notable venues for high-end celebrations include, **Colombo Hilton**, **Galadari Colombo**, and **The Ozo Colombo**, many of which host themed parties with gourmet food, drinks, and live entertainment. The city's nightlife, particularly at places like Rhythm & Blues (R&B) Nightclub, continues well past midnight with live bands and a mix of locals and expatriates.